Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours indigo stands between blue and violet. In the contemporary rainbow map of the chakras it is linked with the **sixth chakra** and the themes of **intuition**, **imagination** and discernment. Blue may ask “what do I need to say?”, indigo “what is beginning to dawn on me?” and violet “what sense does this make for me?”

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root
Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. What can I lean on?



Orange · sacral
Experiencing, pleasure, sensuality. Ask yourself. What does me good?



Yellow · solar plexus
Self-worth, will, decision-making. Ask yourself. What do I want to choose for myself?



Green · heart
Closeness, kindness, relationships. Ask yourself. Where can I be open and still stay with myself?



Blue · throat
Voice, expression, communication. Ask yourself. What do I need to say?



Indigo · third eye
Inner vision, intuition, discernment. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown
Transcendence, meaning, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me a wider sense of meaning?

The rainbow in reality passes smoothly between shades. Seven names help describe its form, the individual bands are not separated by a line. This chakra map too is **a certain way of arranging things**. Older yogic descriptions use other colour associations.

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Ajna, the third eye

The chakras come from the Indian yogic and tantric tradition. The sixth chakra is called Ajna (Sanskrit for “command”, “authority” or “to perceive”). It sits in the middle of the forehead, between the eyebrows. The lotus has two petals with the syllables “ham” and “ksham” and the syllable **Om** belongs to it. It is linked with intuition, reason and the unconscious. Indigo is tied to it only in today's popular version. In classical descriptions rather white elements are given (petals, moon, lingam).

Its theme is **insight**, clarity and trust in your own perception. For women this often turns into questions. Do I trust my hunch? Do I see things as they are, even when they are unpleasant? Do I hear myself?

When the chakra is open. You hear your inner voice and can be guided by it. You do not need to keep reassuring yourself with others. You can see connections and do not have to watch yourself while doing it.

When the chakra is closed. The tradition describes uncertainty about what to trust, excessive thinking, or, on the contrary, ignoring your own hunch. Closed does not mean bad. It is only a signal that you perhaps do not yet allow yourself **your own insight**.

Modern readings place here, for example, mistrust of your own judgement, a need for constant confirmation from outside or a feeling that your own imagination has no place. These are themes for self-reflection. From no single manifestation can the state of a chakra be determined.

How to add indigo when insight is missing

- **Wear it**
  An indigo scarf, jumper or jeans. Something that calms you and holds you.
- **Put it in your home**
  An indigo cushion or blanket, a deep blue lamp. In the evening, when things slow down.
- **Eat it**
  Blueberries, blackberries or red cabbage. Slowly and perhaps in the evening by a window.
- **Take it with you**
  An indigo pebble, hair tie or small piece of jewellery. Something for your pocket that you reach for when you want to slow down for a moment.
- **Paint it**
  Large dark areas and in the middle a small light spot, with no goal and no judging.
- **Give yourself a small thing**
  An indigo pencil, notebook or mug just for pleasure.

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How to supplement indigo when you bury yourself in yourself

When you have looked inward a lot and miss people in the world, you do not need more indigo, but **light and warmth**.

- **Add yellow or orange**
  Light in the dark. A lamp, a candle, an orange scarf.
- **Add white**
  Clarity and purity. White bed linen, white walls.
- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. Wood, natural materials, the ground under your feet.
- **Invite someone over**
  The warmth of others brings a person back from the head into the world.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

You are deciding. You listened to a friend, read several articles and someone else is just sending you their guaranteed opinion. There is more information. But you are no clearer. This is exactly where indigo can get a personal meaning. **Give yourself a moment in which you stop collecting further answers** and notice your own too.

Next to indigo other colours can stand out more. Yellow appears as light in the night, white as a star and green as the shadow of leaves. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a combination of colours.

How to use this map

It is a way of sorting out the themes you are living through. Do you add indigo because you miss depth and a quiet space for your own opinion? Or do you take it away because it is already dim enough in your head? **You choose the meaning.** An added colour does not diagnose your state.

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